

RCF answers to General English 2026

PAPER I

Question 1 (Prepositions) — 5 marks

(1) to (2) without (3) at (4) in (5) for — extra word: of

Question 2 (Verb forms) — 10 marks

(1) answering (2) raise (3) asked (4) is inquired (5) to go (6) will buy (7) have been carrying (8) is (9) evaluated (10) depends

Question 3 (Word choice) — 10 marks

(1) an (2) their (3) other (4) eagle's (5) who (6) Each (7) something (8) the (9) this (10) its

Question 4 (Vocabulary) — 5 marks

(1) provided (2) extremely (3) sent (4) make (5) attention

Question 5 (Word endings) — 5 marks

(1) less (careless) (2) ion (collection) (3) ance (performance) (4) fully (skillfully) (5) ibly (terribly)

Question 6 (Sentence meaning) — 5 marks

(1) (b) (2) (a) (3) (c) (4) (a) (5) (d)

Question 7 — News items (10 marks)

(I) (1) (b) (2) (a) (3) (d) (4) (c) (5) (a)

(II) (6) False (7) Not Given (8) True (9) False (10) False

Question 8 — Paragraph (10 marks) — model answer

Learning another language has many advantages. It opens up better career opportunities, since employers increasingly value staff who can communicate with international clients and partners. It also helps a person understand other cultures more deeply, making travel, friendships and everyday interactions far more rewarding. Research shows that learning a new language sharpens memory, improves problem-solving skills and strengthens overall brain function, especially in young learners. It can also build confidence, as speakers become able to connect with a wider circle of people from different backgrounds. Overall, investing time in learning another language brings lasting benefits for both personal growth and future success.

PAPER II

Question 1 (Word meaning) — 10 marks

(1) leading (2) combining (3) traditional (4) planned (5) converted (6) impact (7) appreciated (8) encourage (9) farsighted (10) long-lasting

Question 2 — Reading text (10 marks)

- (I) (1) False (2) True (3) False (4) False (5) True (6) False (7) False (8) True
(II) (9) (b) (10) (d)

Question 3 — Poem 'The Victor' (5 marks)

- (A) (1) (b) (2) (a) (3) (c) (4) (d)
(B) (1) will

Question 4 — Summary (Employment) (5 marks)

- (1) knowledge (2) financial (3) challenging (4) confidence (5) barriers

Question 5 — Reading text (20 marks)

- (I) (a) True (b) Not Given (c) True (d) Not Given (e) False (f) True
(II) (a) (iv) (b) (iii) (c) (iii)
(III) (a) Paragraph 4 (b) Paragraph 3 (c) Paragraph 2
(IV) (a) they — parents (b) it — materialism / the emphasis on wealth and possessions (c) He — Dr. Beck
(V) (a) accessible (b) luxurious (c) financial (d) showcase (e) guide

Question 6 — Responses (5 marks) — model answers

- (1) "I will really miss you. I hope everything goes well with your studies."
(2) "Shall we inform the school administration about the leaking roof?"
(3) "I am sorry, I won't be able to come to the musical show as I already have other plans."
(4) "Could you please tell me how to get to the canteen?"
(5) "Please, could you dispose of your garbage properly instead of leaving it by the roadside?"

Question 7 — Dialogue completion (5 marks) — model answers

- (1) "That's nice! Where are you planning to go?"
(2) "Is your class teacher going with you?"
(3) "Will you be staying overnight, or coming back the same day?"
(4) "Okay, could you please ask him tonight? I really want to go."
(5) "We're going there to study the plants and rock formations for our biology and geography projects."

Question 8 — Bank dialogue (15 marks) — model answer

You: Good morning. I would like to open a youth savings account, please.

Officer: Good morning. Certainly. May I know why you'd like to open this account?

You: I want to start saving part of my pocket money and the money I earn from tutoring, for future expenses.

Officer: That's a good reason. To open the account, you'll need your birth certificate, your school identity card or a letter from your school, and a passport-sized photograph.

You: I have my birth certificate and school ID with me, but I forgot the photograph. Is that alright?

Officer: That's fine, you may bring it later. Since you're a minor, is a parent or guardian with you?

You: Yes, my mother is here with me.

Officer: Good. She will need to sign as your guardian. Please fill in this application form with your full name, date of birth, address and contact details.

You: Could you tell me where I should sign?

Officer: Sign at the bottom of the second page, and your mother should sign in the guardian's section just below.

You: Thank you. Is there a minimum deposit needed to open the account?

Officer: Yes, the minimum initial deposit is five hundred rupees.

You: Alright, here is five hundred rupees. Thank you for your help.

Officer: You're welcome. Your account will be activated within two working days.

Question 9 — Sentences (5 marks) — model answers

1. The doctor has built a strong reputation for treating patients with great care.
2. She waited with patience while the mechanic repaired her car.
3. He worked hard to overcome his fear of public speaking.
4. The team found a practical solution to reduce plastic waste in the school.
5. Our teacher is flexible about deadlines when students face genuine difficulties.

Question 10 — Bar graph summary (10 marks) — model answer

The bar graph illustrates three main reasons for discontinuing education after the G.C.E. (A/L) examination in the Anuradhapura district in 2015, 2020 and 2025. Financial difficulties were consistently the most common reason, rising steadily from about 400 students in 2015 to roughly 600 in 2020 and nearly 700 in 2025. Limited university placements remained the least common reason throughout, staying fairly stable at around 300 students each year. Family responsibilities, however, increased sharply from about 300 in 2015 to nearly 600 in 2025, overtaking limited university placements by a wide margin. Overall, while financial difficulties affected the largest number of students in every year shown, family responsibilities showed the fastest rate of increase over the ten-year period, highlighting a growing barrier to continuing education.

Question 11 — Letter to a friend (15 marks) — model answer

Dear Amaya,

I hope you are doing well. I'm writing to tell you about a seminar our class organised last Saturday at Sunrise Central College, a needy school not far from town.

We spent almost a month planning it, dividing subjects among group members and preparing simple notes and practice papers for the G.C.E. (O/L) students, with guidance from our teachers.

The response was wonderful — the students listened attentively, asked many questions, and thanked us warmly at the end. Their teachers said it had boosted the students' confidence ahead of their exams.

It was truly rewarding to see how much a small effort could help others, and I hope we can organise more such programmes in future. Write back soon and tell me your news.

Love,
Kavindi

Question 12 — Letter requesting book donation (15 marks) — model answer

The Secretary,
Reading Club,
Royal Central College.

Date

12th September 2026

The Chairman,
Sri Lanka Book Publishers' Association,
Colombo 07.

Dear Sir/Madam,

Request for a Donation of Subject-Related Books

I am writing on behalf of the Reading Club of our school to kindly request a donation of subject-related books for our G.C.E. (A/L) students.

Many of our students come from low-income families and are unable to afford the reference books needed for their studies. A generous donation of books covering subjects such as Science, Mathematics and Languages would greatly support their academic progress and help them prepare confidently for their examinations.

We would be extremely grateful for any contribution you are able to make towards this cause and would be glad to acknowledge your support publicly. Thank you for considering our request.

Yours faithfully,
S. Perera
Secretary, Reading Club

Question 13 — Essay: Sports and studies — extended model answer (5 paragraphs, 350+ words)

Schools today place great emphasis on encouraging students to take part in sports, and this has become a frequent topic of debate among parents and educators. While some believe that sport takes valuable time and energy away from academic work, others argue that it is essential for building a well-rounded personality. Both views have merit, and a closer look at each helps to form a balanced conclusion.

Parents who worry about the effect of sports on studies raise a genuinely important concern. Examinations at every level, especially the G.C.E. (O/L) and (A/L), demand sustained concentration, extensive reading, and countless hours of practice and revision. When students commit several hours a day to training, matches, or tournaments, the time left for homework, tuition classes, and self-study is significantly reduced. Furthermore, intense physical training can leave students physically exhausted, making it difficult for them to focus during lessons or study sessions afterwards. Some parents have witnessed their children's grades decline after taking up a demanding sport, and this experience naturally makes them cautious about how much time should be devoted to games at the expense of academic responsibilities.

On the other hand, those who support strong participation in sports point to benefits that extend far beyond physical fitness. Team sports such as football, netball, and cricket teach students how to cooperate with others, communicate effectively, and work towards a shared goal, skills that are difficult to develop through classroom study alone. Individual sports, meanwhile, build determination, self-discipline, and the ability to cope with both victory and defeat gracefully. Regular physical activity has also been shown to reduce stress and anxiety, improve sleep quality, and increase blood flow to the brain, all of which can actually improve concentration and academic performance rather than harm it. Many successful professionals credit the discipline and leadership qualities they gained from school sports as being just as valuable to their careers as their academic qualifications.

It is also worth considering that the two views are not necessarily in conflict. The real issue is usually not sport itself, but the balance — or lack of it — between sport and study. A student who trains for two or three hours a day without any structured study plan will likely struggle academically, while a student who plays sport moderately and manages their time wisely can enjoy the benefits of both. Schools, parents, and coaches all have a role to play in helping students find this balance, for instance by scheduling training sessions that do not clash with exam periods and by encouraging students to prioritise their studies during critical academic milestones.

In conclusion, both concerns are valid, but the solution lies in balance rather than in choosing one extreme over the other. Sport should be treated as a valuable complement to education rather than a competitor to it. With sensible time management, realistic goals, and support from parents and teachers, students can excel academically while also developing the confidence, discipline, and social skills that come from sport, ultimately growing into healthy, capable, and well-rounded individuals.